

Book Cover Documentation:

Name: Kate Craig

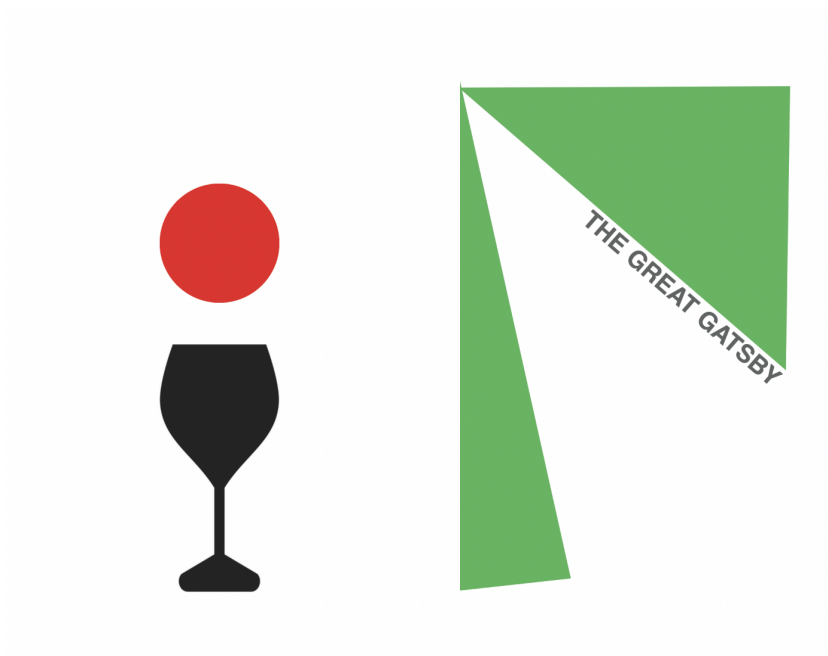
Overview:

Our group chose the book *The Great Gatsby* because we had all watched and read the book, allowing us to all have a really good understanding of design aspects that we could implement into our book covers.

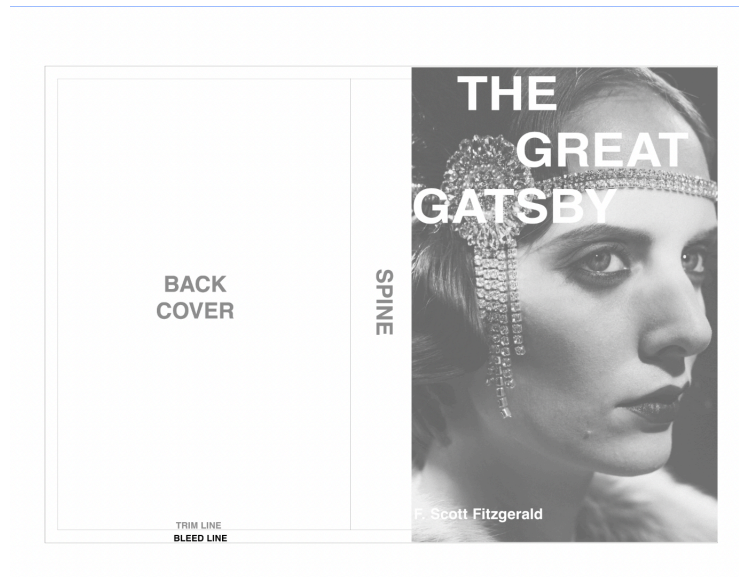
Assigned Style:

My assigned style was the Swiss Typographic Style/International Style which was really exciting for me because I am a very minimalist type of person. I like very simple, clean designs that get a message across clearly and swiftly. This style focuses on a simple color palette, with mainly black and white and one statement color, playing around with different weights and sizes of fonts. Helvetica is one of the most notable fonts for this design style, which is what I used in my project and am currently using. The incredibly clean and simple style makes it harder to portray your message as each item in a design has to be intentional and thought out or else it seems out of place. Another major aspect of the Swiss Typographic style is the use of a grid system. Every aspect of a design must lay in the grid and be aligned within the grid. In photoshop I layered a grid over all of my work and made sure that the text and the shapes worked with the grid to keep the foundations of Swiss typography alive. The focus on functionality rather than intricate design is a good reflection of our society and technology today.

Initial Concepts:



Concept #1: This concept used clean simple lines, and major themes from the book, but it did not feel like it was fully portraying the Swiss Style.



Concept #2: This concept went in an entirely different direction, but seemed a little too simple for the project. I had seen some Swiss Typographic designs using real images, but most were simple shapes that were hinting towards a real object or thing.



Concept #3: This concept was the closest to my original design. It still included some real images (the suit), but started to play around with using simple shapes to get a message across.

Iterations:



Iteration #1: This first iteration included the suit from the initial concept, however, I removed the colored background and changed the main color to green to go along with the green light. I liked this design but I felt like something was off with the suit.



Iteration #2: This iteration took the previous and cleaned it up, and this was the closest iteration to my final design. Instead of using a real image, I used shapes to create a bow-tie look to mimic a suit. I also changed the color to red, as I felt like it fit the Swiss Typography style better, even if it didn't align as much with the book itself. I also changed the text to be bold to use another aspect of swiss typography style and make the title stand out more.



Final Iteration: This final product had very small changes compared to the previous. I adjusted the circle's location to make the design feel less bottom heavy. I also moved the entire right side up high to again make it seem less bottom heavy. I elongated the bow tie a bit as well to fill the space more evenly and fit the grid. I felt like this version took most aspects of the Swiss Typographic style and put them into a book that may not normally feel like it would be in a minimalist style.

Feedback: I gathered feedback from my friends who had also read the book. They helped me decide whether or not to keep the green, and if this fit the book enough. I originally just sent my best friend a photo of my design and she said that it was cool and that she liked what I had done so far. Then I had her look up the swiss typographic style and she looked at what she saw when she looked that up and helped me make minor tweaks to make the design fit better. This helped me with some spacing issues that I was having with the text and how to space it out on the entire page.